USA TRIATHLON

Law Enforcement Bike Course Briefing — Critical Checklist

15 critical items to cover with every officer, face-to-face, before they depart to post.

1. OFFICER ORIENTATION

- ☐ **Provide main race contacts**
  RD + at least one backup contact name/number
- ☐ **Share your personal cell number**
  Officers should reach you directly, anytime during the event

2. EVENT TIMING & RIDER FLOW

- ☐ **Explain event timeline**
  Exact window from first to last rider on course
- ☐ **Describe first-rider arrival**
  Lead athletes arrive quickly after wave starts
- ☐ **Confirm direction & lane of travel**
  Walk the flow on a map if needed

3. BIKE BEHAVIOR & SPEED

- ☐ **Advise on expected speeds**
  Elite/lead athletes can exceed 25–30 mph on open road
- ☐ **Cyclists cannot hear commands**
  Verbal orders won't be heard — use physical/visual cues only
- ☐ **Confirm bikes have right of way**
  All motor traffic should yield to cyclists

4. TRAFFIC & COURSE MANAGEMENT

- ☐ **Keep all vehicles off course**
  No unauthorized vehicles — includes spectator & personal vehicles
- ☐ **Extra caution at closings/turns**
  Over-caution preferred — cyclists may not see signals
- ☐ **No squad cars on live course**
  Use secondary barrier or position vehicle off the road surface

5. BIKE SUPPORT & COURSE VEHICLES

- ☐ **Show or photograph race map**
  If no printed copies, officer takes a phone photo

6. EMERGENCY ACTIONS & PROTOCOLS

- ☐ **Radio first, not 911**
  Coordinate through command dispatch
- ☐ **Route medical/bike requests via dispatch**
  Unless alternate protocols are specified
- ☐ **Confirm course-incident contact**
  RD or designated course marshal, notified immediately

BRIEFING NOTES